

Educating Yourself about Money Matters

Unfortunately, people don't always learn the basics of personal finance from their parents, and the current education system doesn't adequately teach them, either. In fact, the Jump\$tart Coalition for Personal Financial Literacy, whose mission is to improve the financial literacy of young adults, says that the average high school graduate lacks fundamental money management skills and a basic understanding of earning, spending, and saving money. It's no wonder that most people make financial mistakes in their twenties and thirties that they pay for over the next decade or longer. You can avoid these mistakes by educating yourself about basic money matters and practicing good money management.

Where to Go for Help

Where do you start? Books like this one are one source. Check your local bookstore or surf an online bookstore such as Amazon, searching for keywords like "personal finance" or "money management."

Magazines are another source. The bookstands are filled with financial magazines such as *SmartMoney*, *Bloomberg's Personal Finance*, *Money*, and *Kiplinger's Personal Finance*. Some of them are definitely for people who are avid investors or interested in business financial news, but thumb through a few and see if any of them seem readable and interesting without being overwhelming or terribly boring. If you find one, consider subscribing to it.



The less financially savvy you are, the more vulnerable you are to being taken advantage of or falling victim to financial scams. Not everything you